

NextGrid Technologies — POPIA Email Compliance Checklist

5 M365 settings you must enable to avoid R10m fines — plain English | Updated: 25 July 2026 | For SA SMEs 5-50 staff

1. Encryption for sensitive emails

Enable OME for emails containing ID numbers, medical, financial data. POPIA Condition 7: Security Safeguards.

2. Data Loss Prevention (DLP)

Block outbound emails with ID numbers, passport, bank details unless encrypted. Alert finance team.

3. Retention labels

7 years for invoices (Tax Act), 1 year for CVs then auto-delete per POPIA minimality. Setup in Purview.

4. Audit logging

Enable mailbox + SharePoint audit, 1 year retention. Needed for breach report to Regulator in 72h.

5. Access control + MFA

Enforce MFA + Conditional Access + separate admin accounts. Review guest access monthly.

Score

Fail 2+ = Medium Risk, Fail 4+ = High Risk. Book R950 POPIA Health Check — 2hr on-site, 12-page report. 076 948 9154